

OWNLY ONCE

CREDIT READINESS KIT

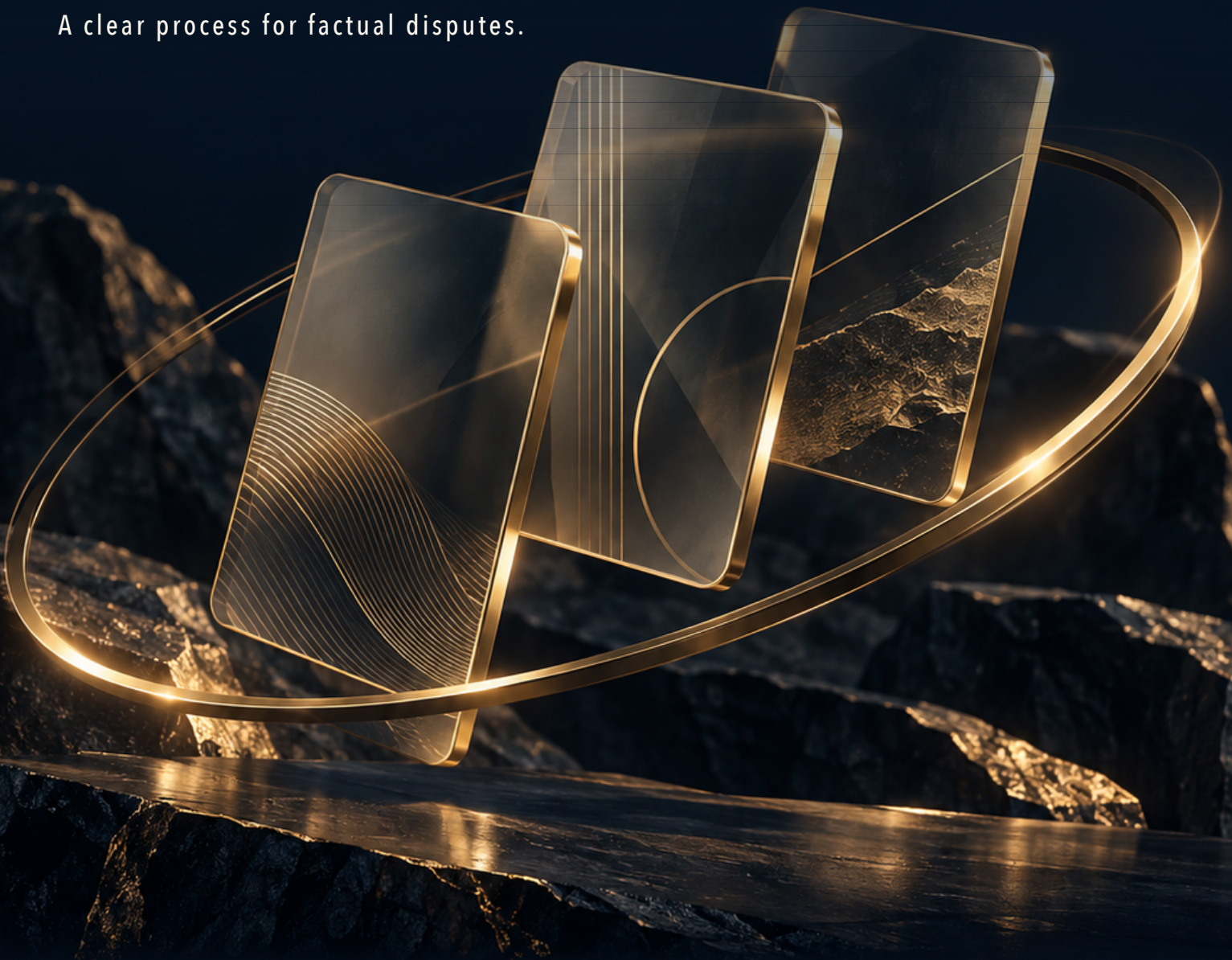
VOLUME 04 OF SIX



CHARGE OFF DISPUTE KIT

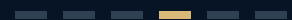
12 customizable letters.

A clear process for factual disputes.



COMPLIMENTARY FIELD GUIDE

itsownlymoney.com



04 / 06

FIELD GUIDE

Understand the issue before writing

A charge-off means a creditor recorded an account as a loss. It does not, by itself, cancel the debt or require the account to disappear from a credit report. This kit focuses on inaccurate reporting and clear documentation.

Look closely at the facts

- Balance and whether payment or settlement is reflected.
- Ownership and the roles of the creditor and collector.
- Specific payment-history months and account status.
- Dates describing the same event, including the first delinquency when relevant.

An update date, a recurring charge-off notation, or two related entries does not automatically establish an error. Explain the actual problem and support it.

If you face a lawsuit or are deciding whether to pay an old debt, seek advice on your situation and state law promptly. A report dispute does not replace a court response.

LETTER DIRECTORY

Choose the letter that fits

Letter	Use
01 First bureau dispute	Use when you can identify an error in a charged-off account.
02 Bureau follow-up	Use after a response leaves a specific error unresolved.
03 Further bureau follow-up	Use only when you have a clear unresolved issue and useful additional detail.
04 Direct furnisher dispute	Send to the designated dispute address of the company that supplied the information.
05 Furnisher follow-up	Use when a prior direct dispute did not resolve the identified error.
06 Incorrect account dates	Use when a particular date is wrong, not simply because date labels differ.
07 Incorrect payment history	Identify the exact month and history code or status you dispute.
08 Debt validation request	For a collector notice. Use the deadline in the notice; do not assume this is a bureau dispute.
09 Collector follow-up	Use to identify what remains unclear after an actual response.
10 Balance or duplicate reporting	Use when the actual balance, ownership, or duplication is incorrect.
11 Paid or settled balance	Use when the completed payment or settlement is not reflected accurately.
12 Reinvestigation procedure	Use after receiving the result of a reporting-company reinvestigation.

These letters are alternatives, not a mandatory twelve-step sequence. Choose the correct recipient and adapt every statement.

BEFORE YOU SEND

Prepare and send your packet

- Replace every bracketed field. Remove statements that do not match your experience.
- Use the company's current official dispute address or online process.
- Identify the disputed account and explain the exact error, the supporting facts, and the correction requested.
- Include copies of relevant documents. Keep your originals. Supply identifying information according to the recipient's requirements.
- Save the completed letter and every attachment. For mailed disputes, certified mail with a return receipt can document delivery.
- Record receipt and response dates. Review the result before deciding on a follow-up.

These templates are educational tools for factual, good-faith disputes. They are not legal advice and do not promise deletion, a score increase, funding, or housing approval.

Current bureau instructions

[Equifax dispute instructions](#)

[Experian dispute instructions](#)

[TransUnion dispute instructions](#)

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

01 First bureau dispute

Use when you can identify an error in a charged-off account.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Reporting company name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Charge-off reporting for [creditor and partial account number]

I am disputing information shown in my [bureau] report dated [date]. The account is listed as [reported status or field].

The specific error is [describe the field and value]. My records show [correct information]. I have attached [records] that support this correction.

Please conduct a reasonable reinvestigation, review the enclosed evidence, and correct inaccurate information or delete information that cannot be verified, as appropriate. Please send written results and an updated report.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

02 Bureau follow-up

Use after a response leaves a specific error unresolved.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Reporting company name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Unresolved error for [creditor and partial account number]

I disputed this account on [date], reference [number]. Your response dated [date] states [exact result].

The remaining issue is [specific error]. The response did not resolve [explain what remains wrong]. The enclosed [new evidence or clarified record] shows [correct fact].

Please review this information and reinvestigate the unresolved issue. Please correct inaccurate reporting or delete information that cannot be verified, as appropriate, and send your written results.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

03 Further bureau follow-up

Use only when you have a clear unresolved issue and useful additional detail.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Reporting company name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Additional evidence for [creditor and partial account number]

My earlier disputes were submitted on [dates], with results received on [dates]. The current report dated [date] still lists [specific field and value].

I am providing additional information: [identify new evidence or a specific omission]. This supports [requested correction] because [factual explanation].

Please investigate this remaining issue in light of the enclosed evidence and provide the written result. If the information is inaccurate, incomplete, or cannot be verified, please modify or delete it as appropriate.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

04 Direct furnisher dispute

Send to the designated dispute address of the company that supplied the information.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Furnisher or original creditor name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Incorrect information furnished for [account identifier]

Your company is furnishing information about this account that I believe is inaccurate. My report from [bureau], dated [date], states [reported information].

The disputed field is [field]. The correct information is [fact], supported by [attached records]. Please investigate this dispute and review all relevant enclosed information.

If your reporting is incorrect, please correct it with each reporting company to which you supplied the information. Please send me your written investigation result.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

05 Furnisher follow-up

Use when a prior direct dispute did not resolve the identified error.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Furnisher or original creditor name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Follow-up for [account identifier]

I wrote to you on [date] about [specific reporting error]. [Describe the actual response received, or state that no response has been received as of a specific date.]

My current report dated [date] still shows [incorrect information]. I am enclosing [additional evidence or clarified records] demonstrating [correct information].

Please investigate the unresolved issue, correct inaccurate information you furnished to reporting companies, and provide your written result.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

06 Incorrect account dates

Use when a particular date is wrong, not simply because date labels differ.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Reporting company name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Date accuracy for [creditor and partial account number]

The report dated [date] lists [name of date field] as [reported date]. I believe this is incorrect because [specific factual reason].

The enclosed [record] shows [correct event and date]. I am comparing the same event, rather than treating the date opened, last update, last payment, and first delinquency as interchangeable.

Please investigate and correct the disputed date. If the error affects how long information is reported, please review that issue as well and provide written results.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

07 Incorrect payment history

Identify the exact month and history code or status you dispute.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Reporting company name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Payment history for [creditor and partial account number]

My report dated [date] shows [reported payment status] for [month and year]. I believe this is inaccurate because [explanation].

The enclosed [payment confirmation, statement, or written agreement] shows [correct information]. The specific correction requested is [correction].

Please review these records, reinvestigate the identified payment history, and correct inaccurate information or delete information that cannot be verified, as appropriate. Please send the result in writing.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

08 Debt validation request

For a collector notice. Use the deadline in the notice; do not assume this is a bureau dispute.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Debt collector name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Dispute of debt referenced in [notice or account number]

I received your validation notice dated [date] concerning [creditor and account reference]. I dispute [all of this debt / the following portion: amount and reason].

Please provide verification of the disputed debt. If different from the current creditor, please provide the name and address of the original creditor. I also request information clarifying [specific balance, payment, or identity issue].

[If true: I am sending this written dispute within the validation period stated in your notice. Please cease collection of the disputed debt until you provide the verification required by applicable law.]

Please send your response to the address above. Enclosed are [relevant documents supporting the dispute].

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

09 Collector follow-up

Use to identify what remains unclear after an actual response.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Debt collector name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Unresolved question for [notice or account number]

I sent a dispute on [date] and received your response dated [date]. The response states [describe the actual response].

The following issue remains unresolved: [specific issue]. The enclosed [document] supports [fact]. Please explain [precise question] and correct any inaccurate information your company is furnishing.

Please provide your written response. This request does not assert a new validation period; my earlier correspondence and the applicable notice dates are listed above.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

10 Balance or duplicate reporting

Use when the actual balance, ownership, or duplication is incorrect.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Reporting company name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Balance reporting for [account identifiers]

My report dated [date] contains these entries: [original creditor, account, balance] and [collector or other entry, account, balance].

I understand that an original account and a collection account may both appear. My dispute concerns this specific error: [describe the incorrect balance, ownership, or true duplicate entry].

The enclosed [sale notice, payment record, statement, or other evidence] supports [correct reporting]. Please investigate each identified entry and correct or delete inaccurate, incomplete, or unverifiable information as appropriate. Please provide the written result.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

11 Paid or settled balance

Use when the completed payment or settlement is not reflected accurately.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Reporting company name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Balance update for [creditor and partial account number]

The report dated [date] shows a balance of [amount] and status of [status]. I completed [payment / settlement] on [date] under [agreement or confirmation].

The enclosed completion letter and payment records show [correct balance and status]. I am requesting correction of the current reporting, not claiming that payment automatically removes accurate prior history.

Please investigate and update the balance and status to reflect the documented outcome. Please send written results and an updated report.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

12 Reinvestigation procedure

Use after receiving the result of a reporting-company reinvestigation.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Reporting company name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Procedure request for [account and dispute reference]

I received your reinvestigation results dated [date] for the account identified above. Under 15 U.S.C. 1681i(a)(6)(B)(iii) and (a)(7), I request a description of the procedure used to determine the accuracy and completeness of the disputed information.

Please include the business name and address of any furnisher contacted, and its telephone number if reasonably available. Please provide the description within 15 days after receiving this request.

The disputed field was [field], and the result states [result]. Please direct your response to the address above.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

FIELD GUIDE

What to do with the response

- Compare the result with the exact issue you raised.
- Save corrections, deletions, and an updated report.
- For a remaining error, identify what was missed and provide useful supporting detail.
- Use the procedure-request letter when you need the description of a completed reporting-company reinvestigation.
- Check current CFPB complaint eligibility before escalating a reporting issue. Include your original dispute, receipt record, response, and remaining error.

A company does not automatically owe deletion because it did not send you an original signed contract. Request correction based on accuracy, completeness, and the applicable investigation duties.

Use the correct clock

Reporting-company disputes generally take 30 days from receipt, with 45 days in some cases. A timely written debt-validation dispute follows different rules. A procedure description is due within 15 days of its request under the cited FCRA provision.

WORKSHEET

Your dispute record

Make one copy for each item and reporting company. Keep this page with the report, evidence, letter, delivery confirmation, and response.

Reporting company and report date

Account or case identifier

Exact reporting error

Evidence and requested correction

Date sent and delivery date

Dispute confirmation or tracking number

Response date and result

Remaining issue and next action

RESOURCES

Sources and next steps

Reference links checked September 14, 2026. Use the official resources below for current instructions and details.

CFPB | Disputing a credit report error

[Open resource](#)

15 U.S.C. 1681i | Reinvestigation procedures

[Open resource](#)

CFPB | When a debt collector contacts you

[Open resource](#)

CFPB | Credit reporting complaint requirements

[Open resource](#)

FTC | Disputing errors on your credit reports

[Open resource](#)

Put your next move on the calendar

Visit **itsownlymoney.com** to explore Ownly ONCE financial readiness coaching and complete the assessment. Bring your goals and a list of questions; keep sensitive report documents in a secure channel.

Explore Ownly ONCE and start your assessment

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